

Assignment #1

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(report: article review)

You will find which article is allocated to you in Canvas, in instructions for Assignment #1

Please submit in Canvas by **Turnitin (pdf)** a report with your Student ID in the file name, 3000 words maximum, with answers to specific questions (see next slides)

Deadline: 18 September, Thursday, 11:59 pm (week 7)

Section 1: Background and contextual analysis

1.1 Analyse how the article follows earlier AI traditions (e.g., symbolic AI, connectionism, cybernetics) by identifying two key publications that influenced its theory or method. How does the article reconcile, challenge, or expand on these influences within their historical context?

1.2 Consider the socio-technical conditions at the time — such as dominant paradigms, funding and social attitudes — and how these shaped the article's problem framing and assumptions. How might these differ if written today?

Section 2: Novelty and societal implications

- 2.1 Identify one major technical concept or approach introduced or popularised by the article. How has this concept propagated across disciplinary boundaries and application domains?
- 2.2 Provide at least one concrete example of its use (or misuse) in a societal context, critically evaluating the implications.

Section 3: Comparative research impact

3.1 How was the article received in academic and non-academic communities over time? Analyse its research impact: consider citations, follow-up studies, and critiques, and identify which factors have been amplified, ignored, or distorted, and why.

3.2 Then, compare it with one contemporary or near-contemporary publication that offers a contrasting view to the article's core claims (e.g., opposing methodology or ethics), and describe the key difference(s).

Section 4: Future impact

4.1 Does the article make explicit or implicit claims about the future of AI or intelligence? Analyse the assumptions used to make these projections. With hindsight, how accurate were they?

4.2 What can this tell us about the limitations and power of futurism in AI research?

Section 5: Ethics of AI

5.1 If ethical considerations are present or absent in the article, how should this be interpreted given the historical moment of its publication? What are the main limitations, biases and risks?

5.2 How would the inclusion of today's ethical frameworks (e.g., fairness, accountability, transparency, privacy) alter the article's claims, limitations or conclusions?

Marking individual report (article review)

	Weight	0-49%	50-64%	65-74%	75-84%	85-100%	Mark
Background and contextual analysis	20%	Not placed in the context of AI research and applications	Partially placed in the context of AI research and applications	Placed in the context of AI research and applications, with a brief or unstructured description	Placed in the context of AI research and applications, with a brief but structured description	Placed in the context of AI research and applications, with a detailed and structured description	
Novelty and societal implications	20%	Significantly mis-identified novelties and implications	Some novelties and implications identified with a brief or unstructured description	Majority of novelties and implications identified with a brief or unstructured description	Majority of novelties and implications identified with a brief but structured description	Majority of novelties and implications identified with a detailed and structured description	
Comparative research impact	20%	No clear or coherent structure or organisation	Poor or incomplete structure and organisation	Structure and organisation are partially appropriate	Structure and organisation are appropriate	Structure and organisation are appropriate and effective	
Future impact	20%	Impact described inadequately	Impact described incompletely	Impact described but without sufficient detail, structure or argumentation	Impact described in sufficient detail, but without strong argumentation	Impact described adequately, with sufficient detail, structure and argumentation	
Ethics of AI: limitations: biases and risks	20%	Significantly mis-identified limitations	Some limitations identified with a brief or unstructured description	Majority of limitations identified but without sufficient detail, structure or argumentation	Majority of limitations identified in sufficient detail but without strong argumentation	Majority of limitations fully identified, with sufficient detail, structure and argumentation	
Total	100%						

In accordance with University policy, penalties apply when work is submitted after 11:59 pm on the due date (Sydney time):

- deduction of 5% of the maximum mark for each calendar day after the due date
- after ten calendar days late, a mark of zero will be awarded
- text matching software (Turnitin) will be used for plagiarism detection